

Business Analysis: Managing Stakeholder Expectations

How to manage stakeholders' expectation as a Business Analyst?

Managing stakeholder expectations as a Business Analyst is fundamentally about alignment, communication, and influence. The core takeaway: you prevent project failure not by perfect documentation, but by keeping stakeholders genuinely aligned - a point strongly emphasized across BA literature and industry guides.

Core Principles for managing stakeholders' expectations:

1. Identify and understand stakeholders early. (using stakeholder map)
2. Analyse the expectations not only gathering (Stakeholder Register)
3. Set clear and realistic expectations. (clarify what solution will not do)
4. Maintaining continuous communication. (workshop facilitation)
5. Build trust and influence without authority.
6. Manage difficult stakeholders proactively.

Agile Product Owner: Managing the Product Backlog

Who is Product Owner and what does he/she do?

A Product Owner is accountable for **maximizing product value** by creating, ordering, and maintaining a transparent backlog. It emphasises four explicit responsibilities:

1. Develop and communicate the Product Goal
2. Create and clearly communicate Product Backlog Items (PBIs)
3. Order the Product Backlog
4. Ensure the backlog is transparent, visible, and understood

Managing Product Backlog:

It involves various processes

1. Creating high-quality backlog items (user story, acceptance criteria)
2. Prioritizing the backlog (must reflect product strategy, customer value, risk reduction)
3. Refining the Backlog Continuously. (It's an ongoing process, refine by splitting large items, remove outdated items, re-estimating and so on.)
4. Align the backlog with product goal
 - Every item should answer that how it contributes to product goal?
 - Does it increase the value?
5. Collaborating with stakeholders (regular stakeholder reviews, evidence-based decision)
6. Working with developers
 - Product Owner (PO) must ensure PBIs are clear
 - Acceptance criteria are testable
 - Questions are answered quickly.

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SCRUM Sprint 1 15 Sep – 22 Sep (5 work items)

Complete sprint

Enable users to upload sleep data and view a basic weekly sleep graph.

SCRUM-1 Import Sleep Data File

Sleep Graph Visual...

Done

Sep 20

SCRUM- 6 Store Sleep Data

User Insights and ...

To Do

SCRUM-2 Validate Sleep Data

Sleep Graph Visual...

To Do

Sep 25

SCRUM- 9 Display weekly sleep data

Sleep Graph Visual...

In Review

SCRUM-10 Calculate Sleep Score

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There's nothing in this sprint

+ Create